players have the luxury of their own rooms! At least some good things emerged from the whole sorry mess.

Weed in the Windies

The Proteas were to tour the West Indies for the first time in 2001. Although the Proteas had played a few ODIs and one Test in the West Indies in 1992, this was the first full-blown South African cricket tour to the islands. You could say that it was a fairly big deal.

Shaun Pollock was the Proteas captain, and when we got to Antigua for the fourth Test, we were leading the series 1-0, with two to play. By the fourth day of the Test, it was already clear that we were going to win the match and, therefore, the series. We just needed a few wickets on the last day, and that would be it – we would have beaten the West Indies in their own backyard.

So, sitting in the changing room at the end of that fourth day, enjoying a few beers with the guys, I suggested that perhaps it might be fun – not to mention highly appropriate – for us to celebrate the sheer momentousness of the occasion by partaking of the local herb. Neil McKenzie was like, 'Great idea! Great idea! Let's do it.' Obviously we had had a few toots by then, and pretty much all the guys were keen to smoke some of Antigua's finest, A-grade marijuana.

As it happened, our liaison officer – the local man who looked after us – was nicknamed 'Smokey'. Seriously. We never knew him by any other name. Great guy too. Anyway, so Roger Telemachus, the Proteas bowler and a good mate of mine, was really keen on the idea. I remember him saying, 'I'm going to smoke the fattest spliff if we win tomorrow.'

So anyway, we had a few more drinks and the idea took root and grew some lovely green leaves. Later, on the bus on the way back to the hotel, I had a quiet word with old Smokey: 'Smokey, what are the chances of organising us some weed? We're probably going to win tomorrow and the boys want to partake.' All he said was, 'Cool.'

Smokey was very cool.

The next day, as we walked into the changing room for the final day's play and the formalities of victory, true to his promise, I saw Smokey standing there with a big plastic bag … and it was just bulging with weed. A whole bunch of loose heads and five already-rolled, fat joints. I had the